

Deep Print (Footprint)

Indicators & Analysis / Deep Indicators | intermediate | 10 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

Deep Print is the core volumetric analysis tool in DeepCharts — a footprint indicator (also known by the registered name Footprint®). It merges price, volume and orderflow into single candles, showing the executed orders at each price tick inside every bar instead of only the bar's open, high, low and close.

Traders use it to spot buyer and seller acceleration, absorption, depletion and bid/ask dominance at each price level. It is fully customizable, from what it counts to how every cell is colored.

What it is

A normal candle tells you where price went. Deep Print tells you what traded to make it go there: at every price tick inside the candle you see the executed volume — total, split by bid and ask, or as delta (the difference between aggressive buying and selling). On top of that base display it can highlight imbalances, the candle's point of control, the value area, volume clusters, single prints, extreme-ratio levels and pullbacks.

When to use it

- You trade orderflow and need to see who is aggressing at each price, not only where price closed.
- You want to identify absorption (heavy volume that fails to move price) and depletion at swing extremes.
- You want per-candle reference levels: volume POC, delta POC and value area.
- You want to monitor several readings at once — Deep Print supports up to 4 side-by-side columns per candle (for example Bid×Ask, Delta and Volume simultaneously).

Quick start

1. Open a chart and add **Deep Print** from the chart's **Indicators** button.
2. Open the indicator settings.
3. In **General settings**, set **Type** to the display you want (start with **Ask/Bid Split** or **Delta + Total Volume**) and **Mode** to **Profile**.
4. Apply — every candle now shows its per-tick executed volume.

The Deep Print Studio

The studio below is the **entire Deep Print dialog, alive** — every settings group from the reference table is wired to live candles. Switch **Type** between all four displays and flip **Profile/Box** mode. Filter the tape with **Min/Max Filter** and change **Input Type** to Aggregate Volume or Num Trades to watch every number recompute. **Zoom the price scale** (mouse wheel over the chart, or – / +) to feel Automatic tick grouping merge and split rows — then set grouping to Manual and zoom again: the rows freeze. Explore all four background **Color Modes** and five **Color Calculations**, single prints, bar-extreme ratios, volume clusters and pullback bars. Press **Replay tape** to stream the trades back in one by one: cells grow, imbalances ignite and die, the POC migrates, and alerts toast (and optionally beep) when a print crosses your threshold. Flip on **3D tiles** and hover a single candle. When the chart looks like yours, hit **Download my settings** — the file lists every dialog section with your values, ready to replicate in DeepCharts.

[WIDGET: deep-print-studio]

Recommended starter configuration

These are suggestions, not defaults — adjust to your market and style:

Area	Suggested start
Type	Delta + Total Volume — delta reading plus total activity in one view
Mode	Profile — histogram-style cells are easier to scan than boxes at first
Input Type	Volume ; switch to Aggregate Volume when hunting split institutional orders (see Different Types of Input Data for Indicators)
Tick grouping	Automatic to begin; set Auto Grouping to Manual with Manual Ticks = 1 if you want rows that never shift when zooming
POC	Enable the Volume POC so each candle's highest-volume price stands out
Value Area	Enable with % Value Area = 70%
Text Format	K on high-volume instruments so 1,000 prints as 1K and cells stay readable

How to read it

- **Cells**: each row inside a candle is one price tick (or group of ticks) with its executed volume. In Ask/Bid Split mode the bid side records aggressive selling and the ask side aggressive buying.
- **Delta**: ask volume minus bid volume at a level. Positive delta means aggressive buyers dominated there; negative means aggressive sellers did.
- **Volume POC**: the highest-volume price of the candle — where the most business was done. **Delta POC** marks the level with the largest net delta.
- **Value area**: the price band containing the configured percentage (for example 70%) of the candle's volume.
- **Imbalances**: when the volume difference between bid and ask at a level exceeds your threshold, the cell is highlighted — one side clearly overpowered the other.
- **Absorption and depletion**: heavy volume at a level with no price progress suggests passive orders absorbing the aggression; shrinking volume into an extreme suggests the move is running out of participants. For worked chart examples, see Reading a Footprint: Worked Examples.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Zoomed view of two or three Deep Print candles with the Volume POC border, the value area highlight and one stacked imbalance annotated dc-en-deep-print-01.png

Settings reference

Grouped exactly as in the indicator dialog.

General settings (Typology)

Setting	What it does
Type	Display basis: Volume (total traded volume), Ask/Bid Split (buy vs sell volume compared), Delta (difference between ask and bid), Delta + Total Volume (combined view)
Mode	Profile (histogram-style representation) or Box (compact boxed values)

Data settings

Setting	What it does
Input Type	Data source: Volume (total traded volume per price), Aggregate Volume (aggregated trades), Order (order-book volume), Num Trades (number of executions per price). See Different Types of Input Data for Indicators for when each is right
Min/Max Filter	Excludes values outside the defined range — reduces noise from very small (or distorting very large) trades

Tick grouping

Setting	What it does
Auto Grouping	Automatic (platform optimizes the grouping) or Manual (you define it)
Auto Group Factor	Controls the tick aggregation level when Automatic is used
Manual Ticks	The grouping quantity when Manual is used
Group Mode	Fixed (constant grouping) or Based on Open/Close (dynamic grouping per candle behavior)

Note: Tick grouping is a shared setting that appears in many DeepCharts indicators (Deep Print, Deep Profile and other profile-based tools) with the same fields. With **Automatic**, row levels can shift when you zoom the price scale — to freeze them, set **Auto Grouping** to **Manual** and **Manual Ticks** to 1.

Plot settings (Bar Style)

Setting	What it does
Bar Marker Width	Thickness of the candle marker
Outside Bar Style	Bar (with shadows) or body-only style
Marker Alignment	Positions the marker to the right or center
Outer Edge Mode	Draws a border outlining the candle body

Background settings

Setting	What it does
Coloration	Customizes the visualization for volume, delta and market imbalances
Border Width	Edge thickness of the volume profile, in pixels
Opacity	Background transparency level

Text settings

Setting	What it does
Font Size	Text size inside footprint cells
Text Format	Automatic (context-adapted), Normal (full numbers, no abbreviation), K (thousands — 1K = 1,000)
Coloration	Customizes how the numbers are rendered for easier interpretation
Dynamic Text Size	Auto-scales text with volume/delta/imbalance amounts — big prints get big numbers
Increase Dynamic Text Size	Strengthens the dynamic sizing effect
Show Texts-by-Zeros	Displays zero-value cells instead of leaving them blank

Background coloration

Setting	What it does
Color Mode	None , Fixed (predefined colors, no gradients), Fading (gradient by intensity), More Colors (multiple user-defined colors — requires Range Definition = USER)
Color Calculation	What drives the color: Volume , Delta , Imbalance , Dominant Volume (largest side per price), Dominant Volume Delta
Min. Vol. Diff. For Imbalance	Minimum bid/ask difference for a level to count as imbalanced
Include Zero on Imbalance	Includes levels with no volume on one side in imbalance analysis
Color Only Dominant Side	Colors only the dominant volume side of each level
Background Inferior Side	Background color of the non-dominant side

Colors

Setting	What it does
Fixed-Volume Color	Single color for total volume
Fixed-Bid Color	Color for the bid (sell) volume
Fixed-Ask Color	Color for the ask (buy) volume

Range

Setting	What it does
Range Definition	Automatic (platform-defined) or USER (custom ranges)
Range (Show Settings)	Opens the custom value-range configuration

POC

Setting	What it does
Enable (Volume POC)	Shows the candle's highest-volume price
Border Color / Border Width (Volume POC)	Highlight color and edge thickness of the Volume POC
Enable (Delta POC)	Shows the level with the largest net delta
Minimum Delta (Delta POC)	Minimum delta value required before the Delta POC displays
Ask Border Color / Bid Border Color (Delta POC)	Border colors for ask-side and bid-side delta POCs
Border Width (Delta POC)	Edge thickness of the Delta POC

Value Area

Setting	What it does
Enable	Toggles the value area display
% Value Area	Percentage of total volume used for the calculation (e.g. 70%)
Highlight	Visually emphasizes the value area on the candles
Outside Color	Color for the area outside the value area
Show Line / Line Color / Line Width	Delimiting line of the value area and its styling

Alerts

Setting	What it does
Enable Sound / Alert Sound	Sound notification toggle and sound selection

Setting	What it does
Enable Message / Alert Message	Popup toggle and the custom message text shown
Alert Minimum Volume	Minimum volume threshold before an alert fires

Single Print

Setting	What it does
Enable	Highlights price levels printed by a single order meeting the criteria
Single Print Min Value	Minimum volume for a single print to be relevant
Enable Only On High Or Low	Restricts highlighting to the candle's extreme prices
Border Width / Border Color	Styling of the single-print highlight

Ratio

Setting	What it does
Enabled	Shows the bid/ask ratio at the bar extremes
Tick Offset	Position of the ratio text relative to the bar high/low
Text Color / Text Size	Ratio text styling
Min Ratio / Maximum Ratio	Minimum value for display and maximum value limit

Vol Cluster

Setting	What it does
Enable	Highlights volume clusters
Min. Volume	Minimum volume for a cluster to count
Increase Volume Based on Tick Grouped	Sums volume across neighboring grouped ticks
Line Width / Back Color / Opacity	Cluster edge thickness, background color and its opacity

Pull Back

Setting	What it does
Enable	Highlights retracement bars — a scalping aid
Pullback Min Source Bar Ticks	Minimum ticks in the source bar
Pullback Min Pullback Ticks	Minimum retracement distance in ticks
Bar Color	Highlight color of pullback bars

Multi-column layouts

Deep Print supports up to 4 simultaneous columns per candle, each showing a different reading side by side — for example Bid×Ask, Delta and Volume at once. To set it up: add multiple Deep Print indicators to the chart, open each one's settings, go to **Sizing** → **Multi Column**, set the column quantity, assign each indicator a unique position. and customize each independently.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Deep Print settings dialog open at the Sizing section with Multi Column configured, next to a chart showing a candle rendered as three side-by-side columns (Bid×Ask, Delta, Volume)

dc-en-deep-print-02.png

Tips and common mistakes

- **Numbers unreadable or cells too small?** Raise **Font Size** or enable **Dynamic Text Size**; set **Text Format** to **K** to compact big numbers; widen **Bar Marker Width**; or use coarser tick grouping so cells are

fewer and taller.

- **Too many imbalance highlights?** Raise **Min. Vol. Diff. For Imbalance**, apply a **Min Filter** on the input data, or enable **Color Only Dominant Side**. Very fine tick grouping also multiplies noise.
- **Your rows don't match another trader's chart?** Compare **Input Type**, tick grouping (Automatic vs Manual, group factor) and **Group Mode** — any of these changes the cells.
- **Want bid×ask numbers and delta at the same time?** Either set **Type** to **Delta + Total Volume**, or build a multi-column layout.
- **POC or value area not visible?** Each has its own **Enable** toggle; the Delta POC additionally requires its **Minimum Delta** threshold to be met.
- **Alert not firing?** Check **Alert Minimum Volume** first — and note that the sound and message toggles are separate.

Related articles

- Reading a Footprint: Worked Examples
- Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta
- Different Types of Input Data for Indicators
- Deep Profile (Volume / Delta Profile)
- Deep Delta
- How to Change the Layout of Indicators